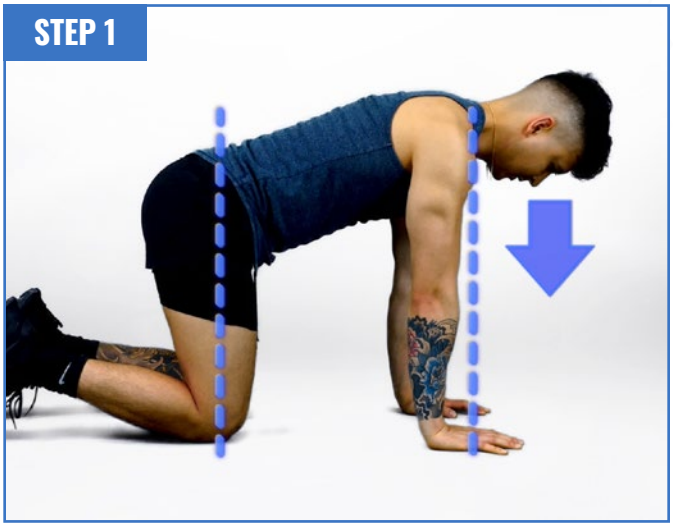
BIRD DOG

STEP 1: SETUP

Get onto all fours with your hands under your shoulders, knees under your hips, and head facing down at the ground in front of you. Your spine should be in a neutral position, with just a very slight arch.

STEP 2

Brace your core, and then without allowing any movement to occur at the low back, kick one of your legs backwards while simultaneously punching the opposite arm forward until they are both fully straightened. Hold this end position for a second or two, come back down to the starting position on all fours, and then repeat with the other arm and leg. Continue alternating until you finish the desired number of reps for each side. Take it slow and control every single rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

To better engage the core muscles, think about kicking the heel of your foot straight back and make a fist with your arm while contracting your arm muscles.
If you are unable to perform the arm and leg movement together, try the modified version with only your legs and then over time try to introduce the arms.
Once this becomes easier, you can hold the end position for longer, even up to 10 seconds.